

Notion Freelancer Dashboard: 5 Client + Project Templates

RenWork Digital Products

Introduction: The Single Source of Truth

Stop juggling spreadsheets, email threads, and sticky notes. This guide outlines the architecture for a high-performance Freelancer Dashboard that operates as a single source of truth. We are building five interconnected databases within Notion. The power lies not in the individual templates, but in the **Relations** and **Rollups** that connect them. By following this blueprint, you will create a system where a change in one database (like marking a project complete) automatically updates your pipeline, invoices, and income logs.

Template 1: Client CRM

This database is the foundation. It holds static information about who you work with.

Database Properties:

- Name**: Title. The company or individual name.
- Status**: Select. Options: *Lead*, *Active*, *Inactive*, *Churned*.
- Tier**: Select. Options: *Platinum*, *Gold*, *Standard*. Use this to prioritize support.
- Contact Email**: Email. Primary point of contact.
- Rate**: Number (Currency). Your standard hourly or project rate for this client.
- Contract Signed**: Checkbox. True/False.
- Projects**: Relation. Link to "Template 2: Project Tracker". This is the critical bridge.

Views to Create:

- Active Clients**: Filter by Status = *Active*. Sort by Tier (Platinum first).
- Pipeline**: Filter by Status = *Lead*. Group by Contact Email to see who you are chasing.
- By Tier**: Group by Tier. Useful for quick segmentation during quarterly reviews.

Automation Ideas:

- Create a button property "Mark Inactive" that sets Status to *Inactive* and Contract Signed to

False.

* Use a filter formula to highlight leads that haven't been contacted in 7 days (requires a "Last Contact" date property).

Template 2: Project Tracker

This is your operational hub. It tracks work-in-progress.

****Database Properties:****

1. ****Name****: Title. Project name.
2. ****Client****: Relation. Link to "Template 1: Client CRM".
3. ****Status****: Status. Options: *Backlog, In Progress, Review, Completed*.
4. ****Deadline****: Date. Target delivery date.
5. ****Deliverables****: Text. Brief description of what is being built.
6. ****Invoiced****: Checkbox. Has the invoice been sent?
7. ****Paid****: Checkbox. Has payment been received?
8. ****Invoices****: Relation. Link to "Template 3: Invoice + Payment Log".

****Views to Create:****

- * ****Active Projects****: Board View. Group by Status. Filter by Status != *Completed*.
- * ****Deadline Pressure****: Table View. Filter by Deadline < Today + 7 days AND Status != *Completed*. Sort by Deadline ascending.
- * ****Per-Client****: Table View. Group by Client. Sort by Deadline. This lets you see all active work for one specific client in one glance.

Template 3: Invoice + Payment Log

Financial accountability lives here.

****Database Properties:****

1. ****Invoice #****: Title. Auto-generated or manual (e.g., INV-2023-001).
2. ****Client****: Relation. Link to "Template 1: Client CRM".
3. ****Project****: Relation. Link to "Template 2: Project Tracker".
4. ****Amount****: Number (Currency). Total billed.
5. ****Due Date****: Date. Payment terms (e.g., Net 30).
6. ****Status****: Select. Options: *Draft, Sent, Paid, Overdue*.
7. ****Payment Date****: Date. When funds hit the bank.

****Views to Create:****

* **Unpaid**: Filter by Status = *Sent* OR *Overdue*. Sort by Due Date ascending.

* **Monthly Income**: Table View. Group by Month (of Payment Date). Add a **Rollup** property

from this database to calculate the Sum of Amounts where Status = *Paid*.

* **By Client**: Table View. Group by Client. Useful for sending monthly statements.

Template 4: Time Log

Track efficiency and ensure you bill for all work.

Database Properties:

1. **Task**: Title. What did you do? (e.g., "Fixed CSS bug").
2. **Project**: Relation. Link to "Template 2: Project Tracker".
3. **Start Time**: Date (Time only).
4. **End Time**: Date (Time only).
5. **Duration**: Number (Hours). *Tip: Use a formula property to auto-calculate (End - Start) in hours to reduce manual entry.*
6. **Billable**: Checkbox. Is this time chargeable?

Views to Create:

* **Weekly Total**: Table View. Group by Week. Add a **Rollup** (Sum of Duration) to see total hours worked per week.

* **Unbilled Hours**: Table View. Filter by Billable = *True* AND Project Status != *Completed*. This highlights work done but not yet invoiced.

* **By Project**: Table View. Group by Project. Sum of Duration. Helps calculate project margins.

Template 5: Content and Deliverable Vault

A library for files, links, and assets.

Database Properties:

1. **Asset Name**: Title.
2. **Type**: Select. Options: *Document*, *Image*, *Code*, *Link*, *Video*.
3. **Project**: Relation. Link to "Template 2: Project Tracker".
4. **Status**: Select. Options: *Draft*, *Needs Review*, *Approved*, *Delivered*.
5. **Version**: Number. Increment for revisions.

6. **File Link**: URL. Link to Dropbox, Drive, or Notion file.
7. **Due**: Date. When this specific asset is needed.

Views to Create:

- * **Needs Review**: Filter by Status = *Needs Review*. Sort by Due Date.
- * **Delivered Archive**: Filter by Status = *Delivered*.
- * **By Project**: Table View. Group by Project.

Interconnection: The Glue

The magic happens when you link these databases. Do not skip this step.

1. **Client to Project**: In *Client CRM*, create a **Relation** to *Project Tracker*. In *Project Tracker*, create the reciprocal **Relation** to *Client CRM*.
2. **Project to Invoice**: In *Project Tracker*, create a **Relation** to *Invoice Log*. In *Invoice Log*, create the reciprocal **Relation** to *Project Tracker*.
3. **Project to Time**: In *Project Tracker*, create a **Relation** to *Time Log*. In *Time Log*, create the reciprocal **Relation** to *Project Tracker*.
4. **Project to Vault**: In *Project Tracker*, create a **Relation** to *Content Vault*. In *Content Vault*, create the reciprocal **Relation** to *Project Tracker*.

Critical Rollups:

- * In *Client CRM*, add a **Rollup** from the *Project Tracker* relation. Property: *Status*. Function: *List*. This shows all active projects for a client directly in the CRM.
- * In *Client CRM*, add a **Rollup** from the *Invoice Log* relation (via Project or direct Client link). Property: *Amount*. Function: *Sum*. Filter: *Status = Paid*. This displays **Lifetime Value (LTV)** per client.
- * In *Project Tracker*, add a **Rollup** from the *Time Log* relation. Property: *Duration*. Function: *Sum*. This shows total hours logged per project.

Daily Workflow

Morning Open (10 mins):

1. Open **Template 2: Project Tracker** (Deadline Pressure View). Identify tasks due in the next 48 hours.
2. Open **Template 5: Content Vault** (Needs Review). Check if any assets are stuck in review.
3. Open **Template 1: Client CRM** (Pipeline). Pick one lead to email.

****Mid-Day Check (5 mins):****

1. Open ****Template 4: Time Log****. Log your morning work hours immediately. Do not wait until night.
2. Check ****Template 3: Invoice Log**** (Unpaid). If an invoice is 3 days past due, send a polite reminder.

****End-of-Day Shutdown (10 mins):****

1. Update ****Template 2: Project Tracker****. Move cards to the next status (e.g., In Progress -> Review).
2. Update ****Template 4: Time Log****. Log afternoon hours.
3. If a project is finished, check the ****Invoiced**** checkbox in the Project Tracker and create a new entry in ****Template 3: Invoice Log****.
4. Close Notion. Your system is now perfectly synced for tomorrow.